Vahan Sahakyan

Senior Backend Engineer
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SUMMARY

Senior Backend Engineer with nearly 5 years of experience designing distributed systems and event-driven services in Go (Golang), Java and TypeScript, using gRPC, Apache Kafka and Kubernetes on Google Cloud Platform (GCP), with working knowledge of Amazon Web Services (AWS). Architected the search, scraping and data pipeline backends of the Forbes Vetted platform.

EXPERIENCE

Optimum Partners (Client: Forbes) | Senior Backend Engineer | Yerevan, Armenia | Jan 2025 - Present

- Architected distributed Go and TypeScript backends for the Vetted platform: search, cursor pagination, scraping, data pipelines.
- Implemented event-driven architecture with Kafka-compatible brokers and async processing, reducing service coupling.
- Designed production MongoDB and Redis schemas, caching strategy, and scaling and consistency patterns.
- Managed multi-tenant Kubernetes on GCP (prod, staging, dev) with namespace isolation and GitOps via Argo CD and Argo Events.
- Led backend delivery on Nexus initiatives from requirements to phased rollouts; mentored peers and, as a TechX mentor (Jun - Aug 2025), interviewed and trained engineers.

Optimum Partners (Client: Forbes) | Full Stack Software Engineer | Yerevan, Armenia | May 2024 - Jan 2025

- Built backend services and integrations for Bertie CMS and Vetted in Go and TypeScript: search, content pipelines, data processing.
- Integrated the Zephr and Cordial platforms and delivered a feature streamlining communication between local npm registries.
- Delivered features at 100% code coverage; documented work with Loom, Markdown and Slab.

Datafoundry | Full Stack Software Engineer | Yerevan, Armenia | Sep 2023 - May 2024

- Led large-scale refactoring of Go and Java microservices, establishing service boundaries and decoupling legacy components.
- Implemented SonarQube and linting across a polyglot codebase, reaching 70%+ unit test coverage and passing quality gates.
- Built reusable Go packages, TypeScript libraries and Angular components for DF mSignal AI, Literature Monitor and mSafety AI.

NWSLAB (Client: Warner Music Group) | Software Engineer | Yerevan, Armenia | Oct 2022 - Sep 2023

- Built backend services and data pipelines in Go and Java for the ADA royalties and publishing system serving DSPs such as Spotify.
- Shaped system-level decisions for Go-based backend services in tech design reviews with the Solutions Architect.
- Established TypeScript patterns and type-safe API contracts for frontend-backend integration in a team distributed across 6 countries.

Datafoundry | Software Engineer | Yerevan, Armenia | Mar 2022 - Oct 2022

- Built a multi-tenant analytics dashboard with role-based access control (4 user roles) for DF mSignal AI on Go and Java backends.
- Optimized state management and refactored legacy codebases using SOC and DRY principles, improving frontend performance.

EDUCATION

- **Bachelor of Performing Arts (BPA)** - Yerevan Komitas State Conservatory 2021
- **Bachelor of Commerce (BCom), Tourism and Hospitality Management** - Yerevan State College of Humanities 2014

SKILLS

- **Programming Languages:** Go (Golang), Java, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, SQL, Bash
- **Frameworks:** gRPC, Protocol Buffers, Gin, Chi, Spring, Hibernate, JPA, Node.js, Express, FastAPI, React, Redux, Angular, RxJS
- **Architecture:** Distributed Systems, Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, CQRS, Event Sourcing, RESTful APIs, GraphQL
- **Cloud Platforms:** Google Cloud Platform (GCP), Amazon Web Services (AWS), Pub/Sub
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, ScyllaDB, ClickHouse, Memcached, Neo4j (Cypher), Firestore, SQLite
- **DevOps:** Docker, Kubernetes (K8s), Helm, Argo CD, Argo Events, Argo Workflows, CI/CD, Fastly, Varnish
- **Observability:** Prometheus, Grafana, Jaeger, Loki, Distributed Tracing
- **Tools:** Apache Kafka, Redpanda, WebSockets, Git, Linux, Jest, SonarQube, Nx, JFrog Artifactory

PROJECTS

Distributed Social Network (Go, gRPC, Redpanda) | github.com/vahan-sahakyan/distributed-social-network

- Built 10 Go microservices communicating over gRPC, with Redpanda (Kafka-compatible) event streaming, CQRS and event sourcing.
- Implemented polyglot persistence (ScyllaDB, PostgreSQL, ClickHouse event store, Memcached) with full observability (Prometheus, Grafana, Jaeger, Loki) and Helm charts for Kubernetes.

CERTIFICATIONS & COURSES

- Neo4j Certified Professional (NCP) | MongoDB: Indexing Design Fundamentals | Claude with Google Cloud's Vertex AI
- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) with Practice Tests - KodeKloud course, Udemy
- C++ Programming mentorship - Believer Programmers' Club of Armenia, mentor Artak Yenokyan (Siemens EDA), 2018 - 2019

LANGUAGES

- English (Full Professional) | Russian (Full Professional) | Armenian (Native) | Japanese (Elementary)